What to write on your certificates:

Certificates are given to participants at the end of a training course to recognise their achievement, they can be used to show potential employers that a specific skill or knowledge has been gained by the candidate and are particularly beneficial as it shows potential employers progress in an individual's career.

At the end of a training session students should receive a certificate for their efforts. This not only shows others what they have learnt but may also be required for insurance purposes.

Your certificate should have the following:

- Course title
- Students name
- Date it was achieved
- Tutor's name / signature (and date)
- Company branding / logo
- Certificate number
- Unique CPD accreditation number

Course title:

This informs insurance companies what the course was that the participant attended. The title needs to be the same as the title stated on the accreditation application.

Students name:

Informs insurance companies, who achieved it. Make sure you spell any complicated names correctly.

Date it was achieved:

Informs potential employers, insurance companies and staff when the student achieved their certificate. It also gives an indication on how experienced an individual is in a specific subject or skill.

Tutors name:

This can be useful to know if the certificate needs to be traced back to the company/business.

Company branding and logos

It lets others know who was the company/business that provided the training and is free marketing for you. If your student has enjoyed their training with you, they will talk about it.

Certificate number and security

Adding a certificate number to each one will reduce the risk of your certificates being used fraudulently and will allow them to be traced. You will also need to keep a record of who achieved what and when at your end, just in case a certificate needs to be traced back to the business. Watermarks can also be added making it difficult to replicate.

Unique accreditation course number

When your course has been accredited you will receive a unique accreditation number with our logo that you can use on your certificates. These can be cross referenced against the CPD Register and demonstrates that it has gone through our assessment process and met our ACCREDITATION framework.

Certificate Wording

We would recommend using the one of the following on your certificates, remember CPD is not a qualification and should not be substituted for one either. We do not recommend using 'Level' as this implies that it is a qualification and can be misleading, unless your material has been mapped against a qualification of the same standard and has gone through our assessment process, then it should state CPD in the title for example; CPD Level 3 …. or Level 3 CPD …

We would recommend using one of the following when writing your certificates:

- Certificate of Achievement
- Certificate of Attendance
- Certificate of Completion

Designing your certificate:

Canva is a design tool that can be used to create professional looking certificates. You can add your branding, graphics and choose the font style and text layout. Adobe Editor is another one where you can create professional looking documents, we do not recommend creating a certificate in Word. We do have a certificate template available to use in the CPD Resources if you are not able to design your own.

Print any certificates on card if possible, this makes them more durable and professional looking.